the PRI level have been demanding scrapping of the scheme as it infringes the idea of decentralised planning. In it's place, they want the funds to be given to the local bodies directly for the same kind of works specified by the MPLADS.[88]

The MOSPI (Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation) issued ***revised guidelines*** for the Scheme in ***August, 2012*** with following salient features – .

i. Assistance to physically challenged persons upto maximum of Rs.10 lakh per year for purchase of *tri-cycles* and *artificial limbs* have been allowed,

ii. Ambulances/hearse vans under the District Authority/CMO/Civil Surgeon of the district can now also be operated through private organizations,

iii. MPs allowed to recommend eligible works upto Rs.10 lakh per year outside the constituency for Lok Sabha MPs and outside States for Rajya Sabha MPs.

iv. Advances to Government implementing agencies increased to the ratio of 75:25 (from 50:50).

v. Contingency Funds of 0.5% have been increased to 2% of the annual entitlement as administrative expenses.

vi. Works can also be implemented in areas affected by *man-made calamities* like chemical, biological and radiological hazards.

vii. Mobile Library for Government Educational Institutions/Public Libraries now permissible.

viii. Works from out of the shelf of MGNREG. A project approved by the Zilla Panchayat for the year may also be recommended under the MPLAD Scheme. Similarly, ***convergence*** of MPLADS funds with Panchayat Yuva Krida aur Khel Abhiyan (PYKKA) and Urban Sports Infrastructure Scheme (USIS) for creation of durable sports assets from out of the shelf of PYKKA Projects has been allowed.

ix. Funds can be used now for construction of Railway Halt Stations to facilitate the local community for boarding/deboarding the train.

x. An MP has been entitled for setting up of MPLADS Facilitation Centre in the Nodal District for which MPLADS funds not